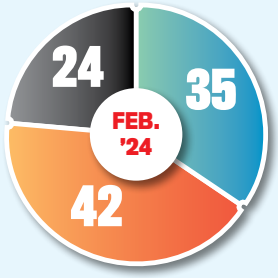
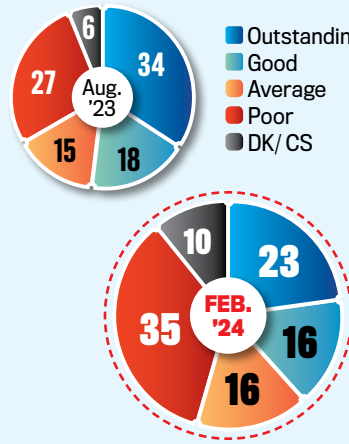
Q. Has your opinion about the politics and leadership of Rahul Gandhi improved following the Bharat Jodo Nyay Yatra?



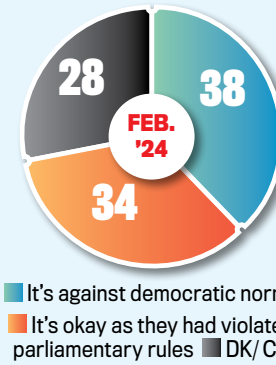
Too little, too late? The Congress leader has done the miles, but it's not enough

Q. How do you rate Rahul Gandhi's performance as an Opposition leader?



The Congress leader, it seems, can't walk the talk

Q. How do you view the mass suspension of Opposition members during the winter session of Parliament?



The violation of democratic norms hasn't exercised the minds of respondents much

All figures in % and rounded off



MILES TO GO Rahul Gandhi greets supporters as the BJNY rally passes through Bokaro, Jharkhand, Feb. 4

ANI

gallery—as, according to him, they are likely to be thrown out of Parliament in the Lok Sabha polls this summer. That's a decision voters may or may not take at the voting booth, but it's significant that a section of them don't want to see the ouster of Opposition leaders from Parliament the way it did during the winter session when 146 members of both houses were suspended. The government justified it saying the leaders violated parliamentary norms by bringing placards and storming the well, while the Opposition says they were simply demanding a statement from the prime minister or Union home minister Amit Shah on the security breach that took place on December 13. In the MOTN poll, 38 per cent respondents say the mass suspension of Opposition leaders was against democratic norms. But then, 34 per cent also back the action saying the leaders violated parliamentary rules.

Such split verdicts reflect the public mood—they are willing to listen to the Opposition, but want a strong narrative that makes sense to the masses. The Opposition isn't helping either, they have a few issues to build on, but right now they are neither fashioning a coherent narrative nor showing a united stand. ■